

D2C Company Classification Rules

1. Key Principles

- Multi-select Tagging: Companies can have multiple category tags
- Primary + Secondary: Identify one primary category and multiple secondary categories
- Threshold Rules: Tag categories with 10+ products OR 15%+ of catalog
- B2C Focus: Only include companies that sell directly to consumers

2. LEVEL 1: PRODUCT VS SERVICE CLASSIFICATION

2.1 Product (Physical Goods)/e-commerce

Primary Indicators:

- Shopping cart functionality present
- "Add to cart" or "Add to bag" buttons
- Physical product images with multiple angles
- Shipping/delivery information on site
- Size, color, or variant selectors
- Inventory status ("In stock", "Out of stock")
- Physical specifications (dimensions, weight, materials)

URL Patterns:

- /products/, /shop/, /collections/, /catalog/, /store/

Page Elements:

- Product detail pages with SKUs
- Size charts or fit guides
- Care instructions
- Material composition
- "Free shipping" or "Ships in X days"

Keywords:

- "Materials:", "Dimensions:", "Weight:", "Care instructions"
- "Free returns", "Exchange policy"
- "In stock", "Limited edition", "Sold out"

2.2 Service (Digital/Subscription)

Primary Indicators:

- Pricing/plans page with tiered options
- "Sign up", "Subscribe", "Start free trial" CTAs
- Monthly/annual billing options
- Feature comparison tables
- Account/dashboard access
- App download links (iOS/Android)

URL Patterns:

- /pricing/, /plans/, /subscribe/, /signup/, /membership/

Page Elements:

- Subscription tiers (Basic, Premium, Pro)
- "Cancel anytime" messaging
- Login/account portal
- User testimonials about service experience

Keywords:

- "Access to", "Unlimited", "Members get", "Subscription"
- "Stream", "Download", "Cloud", "Platform"
- "Per month", "Billed annually", "Free trial"

3. LEVEL 2: PRODUCT CATEGORY CLASSIFICATION

Tagging Rules:

- Primary Category = largest product count or most prominent on homepage
- Secondary Categories = any category with 10+ products OR 15%+ of total catalog
- Tag ALL applicable categories

3.1 Fashion & Apparel

Include if selling:

- Tops: shirts, t-shirts, blouses, sweaters, hoodies, tank tops, cardigans
- Bottoms: pants, jeans, shorts, skirts, leggings, trousers
- Dresses & jumpsuits
- Outerwear: jackets, coats, blazers, vests
- Activewear: workout clothes, yoga pants, sports bras, athletic shorts
- Loungewear & sleepwear: pajamas, robes, loungewear sets
- Swimwear: swimsuits, bikinis, board shorts
- Underwear & intimates: bras, underwear, shapewear, lingerie

Size Indicators:

- XS, S, M, L, XL, XXL+
- Numeric sizes: 0-20, 28-42 (waist)
- EU/UK/US size conversions

Material Keywords:

- Cotton, polyester, silk, wool, cashmere, linen, denim, leather, suede, nylon, spandex

Exclude from Fashion:

- Shoes/footwear (separate category)
- Bags, watches, eyewear (Fashion Accessories category)
- Jewelry (separate category)

3.2 Footwear

Include if selling:

- Sneakers & athletic shoes
- Boots (ankle, knee-high, hiking, work boots)
- Sandals & slides
- Heels & pumps
- Flats & loafers
- Dress shoes & oxfords
- Slippers & house shoes
- Specialty: running shoes, basketball shoes, soccer cleats

Size Indicators:

- Numeric shoe sizes: US (5-15), EU (35-50), UK (3-14)
- Width options: Narrow, Medium, Wide
- Men's, Women's, Kids' shoe sizes

Product Details:

- Sole material, upper material
- "Cushioning", "Arch support", "Waterproof"
- Shoe care instructions

3.3 Fashion Accessories

Include if selling:

- Bags: backpacks, handbags, totes, crossbody, clutches, duffel bags, luggage
- Watches: smartwatches, analog, digital, luxury watches, fashion watches, sport watches
- Eyewear: prescription glasses, sunglasses, blue light glasses, reading glasses, safety eyewear
- Belts & suspenders
- Hats & caps: baseball caps, beanies, fedoras, bucket hats
- Scarves, bandanas, wraps
- Gloves & mittens
- Hair accessories: clips, scrunchies, headbands
- Phone cases & tech accessories
- Wallets & cardholders
- Socks & hosiery (if standalone, not with clothing)

Product Indicators:

- Material: leather, canvas, nylon, metal, acetate, titanium
- For eyewear: frame dimensions, lens types (polarized, UV protection), prescription options
- For watches: water resistance, movement type (quartz, automatic), strap material
- For bags: dimensions (L x W x H), strap length, capacity, number of compartments

Exclude from Fashion Accessories:

- Fine jewelry, engagement rings (see Jewelry category)

3.4 Jewelry

Include if selling:

- Necklaces, chains, pendants
- Earrings: studs, hoops, dangles, ear cuffs
- Bracelets, bangles, cuffs
- Rings: fashion rings, statement rings, stackable rings
- Anklets, toe rings
- Body jewelry: belly rings, nose rings

- Fine jewelry (gold, silver, platinum)
- Fashion jewelry, costume jewelry
- Engagement rings, wedding bands
- Custom/personalized jewelry
- Birthstone jewelry, charm jewelry

Product Indicators:

- Metal purity: 10K, 14K, 18K, 24K gold, sterling silver (.925), platinum
- Gemstones: diamonds, sapphires, rubies, emeralds, semi-precious stones
- Carat weight, clarity, cut, color (for diamonds)
- Chain length, ring size
- "Handcrafted", "Ethically sourced", "Conflict-free diamonds"
- Hypoallergenic, nickel-free (for sensitive skin)

Keywords:

- "Fine jewelry", "Artisan-made", "Hand-forged"
- "Lab-grown diamonds", "Natural gemstones"
- "Engraving available", "Custom design"

3.5 Beauty & Personal Care

Include if selling:

- Skincare: cleansers, toners, serums, moisturizers, sunscreen, face masks, exfoliants
- Makeup: foundation, concealer, lipstick, eyeshadow, mascara, blush, bronzer
- Haircare: shampoo, conditioner, styling products, hair treatments, hair masks
- Fragrance: perfume, cologne, body spray, scented oils
- Men's grooming: beard oil, shaving cream, aftershave, men's skincare
- Bath & body: body wash, soap, bath bombs, deodorant, body lotions
- Nail care: nail polish, nail treatments

Product Indicators:

- Ingredient lists (hyaluronic acid, retinol, vitamin C, niacinamide)
- Skin type recommendations (oily, dry, combination, sensitive)
- "Clean beauty", "Cruelty-free", "Vegan", "Paraben-free"
- Volume/size: ml, oz, fl oz
- Shade ranges for makeup

3.6 Food & Beverage

Include if selling:

- Snacks: chips, crackers, nuts, trail mix, protein bars, jerky, candy, cookies
- Meal kits & prepared meals: subscription meal kits, ready-to-eat meals
- Coffee & tea: coffee beans, ground coffee, pods, tea bags, loose leaf tea, matcha

- Alcohol: wine, beer, spirits, cocktail kits, mixers
- Supplements: vitamins, protein powder, collagen, probiotics, omega-3
- Specialty foods: organic, vegan, keto, gluten-free, paleo products
- Condiments, spices, sauces, nut butters
- Beverages: sparkling water, kombucha, juice, energy drinks

Product Indicators:

- Nutrition facts, ingredient lists, serving size
- Allergen information
- Dietary labels: "Gluten-free", "Organic", "Non-GMO", "Vegan"
- Expiration dates, shelf life

3.7 Home & Living

Include if selling:

- Furniture: sofas, chairs, tables, beds, desks, cabinets, shelves, storage
- Home decor: wall art, throw pillows, candles, rugs, mirrors, vases, lighting
- Bedding & bath: sheets, duvet covers, comforters, pillows, towels, bathrobes
- Mattresses & sleep products: mattresses, mattress toppers, bed frames, weighted blankets, sleep aids
- Kitchen & dining: cookware, dinnerware, cutlery, small appliances, storage containers
- Cleaning products: eco-friendly cleaners, detergents, cleaning tools
- Smart home: smart speakers, smart lighting, thermostats, security cameras
- Outdoor furniture, patio decor

Product Indicators:

- Dimensions (L x W x H for furniture)
- Material: wood, metal, fabric, glass, ceramic
- Assembly required or assembled
- Weight capacity for furniture
- Thread count for bedding
- For mattresses: firmness levels (soft, medium, firm), sizes, sleep trial periods

3.8 Health & Wellness (Physical Products)

Include if selling:

- Fitness equipment: dumbbells, kettlebells, resistance bands, yoga mats, exercise bikes
- Supplements & nutrition (if not under Food & Beverage)
- Sexual wellness: contraceptives, lubricants, intimacy products, adult toys
- Mental health & self-care: aromatherapy, essential oils, meditation cushions, journals
- Medical devices: blood pressure monitors, thermometers, first aid kits, compression wear
- Massage tools, foam rollers, recovery equipment

Product Indicators:

- FDA approved, medical grade
- Clinical studies, certifications
- Dosage information for supplements

3.9 Baby & Kids

Include if selling:

- Baby care: diapers, wipes, bottles, pacifiers, baby monitors, strollers, car seats
- Toys & games: educational toys, puzzles, board games, action figures, dolls, outdoor toys
- Kids' furniture: cribs, toddler beds, desks, toy storage
- Baby skincare, baby bath products
- Learning kits, books, science kits

Product Indicators:

- Age recommendations (0-3 months, 1-3 years, 4-8 years)
- Safety certifications (CPSC, ASTM, CE)
- "BPA-free", "Non-toxic", choking hazard warnings

Exclude:

- Kids' clothing (tag as Fashion & Apparel)
- Kids' shoes (tag as Footwear)

3.10 Pet Products

Include if selling:

- Pet food: dog food, cat food, treats, chews, specialty diet foods
- Pet supplies: collars, leashes, beds, crates, toys, bowls, grooming products
- Pet healthcare: flea treatments, dental care, supplements, medications (OTC)
- Pet furniture: cat trees, scratching posts
- Pet clothing, costumes

Product Indicators:

- Pet type: dogs, cats, birds, fish, reptiles, small animals
- Size/breed recommendations
- Age: puppy, adult, senior
- "Vet recommended", "Veterinarian formulated"

3.11 Electronics & Tech

Include if selling:

- Consumer electronics: smartphones, tablets, laptops, monitors, cameras, drones
- Wearables: smartwatches, fitness trackers, smart rings, VR headsets
- Audio: headphones, earbuds, speakers, soundbars, microphones
- Gaming: consoles, gaming accessories (keyboards, mice, controllers), gaming chairs

- Tech accessories: phone cases, chargers, cables, power banks, webcams

Product Indicators:

- Technical specs: RAM, storage, processor, battery life
- Compatibility: iOS, Android, Windows, Mac
- Warranty information
- "Wireless", "Bluetooth", "USB-C"

3.12 Outdoor & Recreation

Include if selling:

- Camping & hiking: tents, sleeping bags, backpacks, camp stoves, coolers
- Sports equipment: bicycles, skateboards, surfboards, paddleboards, fishing gear, golf clubs
- Outdoor gear: grills, BBQ accessories, gardening tools, outdoor lighting
- Hammocks, outdoor furniture (can overlap with Home & Living)

Product Indicators:

- Waterproof, weather-resistant
- Weight capacity, portability
- UV protection

3.13 Office & Stationery

Include if selling:

- Notebooks, journals, planners, calendars
- Pens, pencils, markers, highlighters
- Desk organizers, file storage
- Art supplies, craft materials
- Desk accessories, ergonomic products
- Business cards, stationery sets

Product Indicators:

- Paper quality, page count
- Binding type: spiral, hardcover
- "Acid-free paper", "Recycled materials"

4. LEVEL 3: SERVICE CATEGORY CLASSIFICATION

4.1 EdTech (Education Technology)

Include if offering:

- Online courses, learning platforms
- Language learning apps (Duolingo, Babbel, Rosetta Stone)
- Skill development (Skillshare, MasterClass, Udemy)
- K-12 tutoring, test prep (SAT, GRE, GMAT)
- Coding bootcamps, programming courses

Service Indicators:

- Course catalog, video lessons, progress tracking
- Certificates of completion
- "Learn at your own pace"

4.2 FinTech (Financial Technology)

Include if offering:

- Digital banking: checking/savings accounts, debit cards
- Payment services: digital wallets, P2P payments, buy now pay later
- Investment: investment apps, robo-advisors, cryptocurrency
- Credit & lending: credit cards, loans, credit monitoring
- Budgeting: budgeting apps, expense tracking

Service Indicators:

- "FDIC insured", "SEC registered"
- "No monthly fees", APY rates

4.3 Health & Wellness Services

Include if offering:

- Telemedicine: virtual doctor visits, online prescriptions
- Mental health: therapy apps, counseling (Talkspace, BetterHelp)
- Fitness apps: workout apps, yoga apps, meditation apps
- Nutrition: meal planning, calorie tracking

Service Indicators:

- Licensed professionals, HIPAA compliance

- "Talk to a doctor in minutes"

4.4 Telecom

Include if offering:

- Mobile phone plans (prepaid, postpaid)
- Home internet services
- MVNOs (Mobile Virtual Network Operators)
- 5G services

Service Indicators:

- Data limits or unlimited data
- Coverage maps, "No contracts"

4.5 Streaming Platform / OTT

Include if offering:

- Video streaming: movies, TV shows, original series (Netflix, Hulu, Disney+, HBO Max)
- Sports streaming: live sports (ESPN+, DAZN, NFL Game Pass)
- Live TV streaming: cable replacement (YouTube TV, Sling TV)

Service Indicators:

- Content library size, simultaneous streams
- Download for offline, 4K/HD quality
- "Original content", "Exclusive shows"

4.6 Music & Audio Streaming

Include if offering:

- Music streaming: on-demand music (Spotify, Apple Music, Tidal)
- Podcast platforms: podcast streaming, premium podcasts
- Radio streaming: internet radio (Pandora, SiriusXM)
- Audiobook streaming (Audible, Scribd)

Service Indicators:

- Music library size (millions of songs)
- Audio quality: standard, lossless, spatial audio
- "Ad-free listening", offline downloads

4.7 Gaming

Include if offering:

- Cloud gaming: game streaming (Xbox Cloud Gaming, GeForce Now)
- Game subscriptions: game libraries (Xbox Game Pass, PlayStation Plus, EA Play)
- Mobile gaming subscriptions (Apple Arcade, Google Play Pass)

Service Indicators:

- Game library size, platform compatibility
- "Day-one releases", "Exclusive titles"

4.8 News & Media

Include if offering:

- News subscriptions: digital news (NYT, WSJ, Washington Post)
- Magazine subscriptions: digital magazines (The New Yorker, Wired)
- Newsletter platforms: premium newsletters (Substack)
- E-reading subscriptions: e-books (Kindle Unlimited)

Service Indicators:

- Article limits vs unlimited access (paywall)
- "Ad-free reading", archive access

4.9 Insurance

Include if offering:

- Health insurance, life insurance, auto insurance
- Home insurance: homeowners, renters
- Pet insurance, travel insurance

Service Indicators:

- Quote tools, instant quotes
- "Get covered in minutes"
- Coverage amounts, premiums, deductibles

4.10 Travel & Ticketing

Include if offering:

- Travel booking: flights, hotels, vacation packages (Expedia, Booking.com)
- Event ticketing: concerts, sports, theater (Ticketmaster, StubHub)
- Experience bookings: tours, activities (Viator, GetYourGuide)
- Vacation rentals (Airbnb, VRBO)

Service Indicators:

- Booking fees, cancellation policies
- "Best price guarantee", user reviews
- Instant confirmation, digital tickets

4.11 Food Delivery

Include if offering:

- Meal kit delivery: subscription meal kits (HelloFresh, Blue Apron, Home Chef)
- Prepared meal delivery: ready-to-eat meals (Factor, Freshly)
- Restaurant delivery subscriptions (DoorDash DashPass, Uber Eats Pass)
- Grocery delivery subscriptions (Instacart+, Amazon Fresh)

Service Indicators:

- Recipes per week, serving sizes, dietary preferences
- Skip weeks, pause subscription
- "Pre-portioned ingredients", "Free delivery"

4.12 Transportation Booking

Include if offering:

- Ride-sharing subscriptions (Uber Pass, Lyft Pink)
- Car rental subscriptions, car-sharing (Zipcar)
- Bike-sharing, scooter-sharing memberships (Lime, Bird)
- EV charging network memberships
- Parking subscriptions (SpotHero, ParkWhiz)

Service Indicators:

- Monthly fee for discounted rides
- Ride credits, unlimited usage
- "Save on every ride", "Priority access"

5. SPECIAL CASES & EDGE CASE HANDLING

5.1 Multi-Category Brands

Tagging Logic:

- Scan all product categories/collections on the website
- Count total products/SKUs in each major category
- Primary Category = highest product count OR most prominent on homepage
- Secondary Categories = 10+ products OR 15%+ of catalog OR dedicated nav section

Example: Nike

- Products: 60% Footwear, 35% Fashion & Apparel, 5% Accessories
- Primary: Footwear
- Secondary: Fashion & Apparel, Accessories

5.2 Hybrid Product-Service Companies

Classification Rule: Classify based on PRIMARY business model and revenue source

Examples:

- Stitch Fix → Service (Fashion styling is the core offering)
- Rent the Runway → Service (Rental subscription model)
- BarkBox → Product (Pet Products) + Business Model: Subscription
- Dollar Shave Club → Product (Beauty) + Business Model: Subscription
- Blue Apron → Service (Meal Kits & Food Delivery)

5.3 B2C vs. B2B Borderline Cases

Exclude if:

- Primary customers are businesses
- Enterprise pricing, sales team contact required
- No consumer self-checkout

Include if:

- Anyone can purchase without business verification
- Consumer-friendly checkout
- Marketed to individuals/families

5.4 Subscription Boxes - Physical Products

Rule: Tag as Product in the relevant category + Business Model = Subscription

- FabFitFun → Product: Beauty & Personal Care, Home & Living
- Ipsy → Product: Beauty & Personal Care

- Book of the Month → Product: Content & Media

Step 0: Determine if D2C or Exclude

CRITICAL: First check if the company is D2C. If NOT D2C, output "Not Required" and skip classification.

Output "Not Required" for:

- B2B SaaS companies (Salesforce, Slack, HubSpot, Monday.com)
- Enterprise software (SAP, Oracle, ServiceNow)
- IT services companies (Accenture, TCS, Infosys)
- Manufacturing companies (not selling D2C)
- Wholesale/B2B distributors
- Professional services (consulting, legal, accounting)
- Infrastructure/cloud providers (AWS, Azure, Google Cloud - unless consumer-facing product)
- Any company that requires enterprise sales, RFPs, or sales team contact
- Any company without direct consumer checkout

Proceed with classification ONLY if:

- Sells directly to individual consumers (not businesses)
- Has self-serve checkout/purchase flow
- Marketed to individuals/families/households
- Pricing is transparent and accessible to any consumer
-